

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3340

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Gender
Female
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When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
August 2025
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
After completing a high school diploma with a focus on mathematics and physics, I earned a BSc (2015–2019) and MSc (2019–2021) in Psychology from the University of Zurich, Switzerland. During my Master's, I specialized in Neuroscience and Cognition and conducted my thesis in the Department of Neuropsychology. Since autumn 2021, I have been pursuing a PhD in Psychology at the University of Zurich and a PhD in Neuroscience at the Neuroscience Center Zurich, a joint program between ETH Zurich and the University of Zurich. My PhD project investigates how information from different senses is integrated in the brains of children, and therefore involves conducting research with children aged 6 to 12 years.
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
I have always wanted to live and work abroad, not just as a visitor but as someone actively engaged with the local community. During my travels, I found the most meaningful moments were those spent connecting with locals, learning from their perspectives, and immersing myself in new cultural contexts. Becoming a Science Corps Fellow would allow me to combine this passion for cultural exchange with my background in science and education. It would not only allow me to live in and experience a different culture, but also to give something valuable back by sharing knowledge and sparking curiosity in others. I am especially drawn to Science Corps because of its mission to bring scientific knowledge and educational opportunities to communities that may otherwise have limited access. I strongly believe that science should be accessible to everyone, regardless of geography or background. The chance to contribute to curriculum development, inspire students, and promote critical thinking in underserved areas feels like a deeply meaningful way to apply my experience.

During my PhD, I realized how much I enjoy teaching children about science. Their natural curiosity and enthusiasm are incredibly energizing, and it's deeply rewarding to see them light up when they discover something new. I would love to bring that excitement to more students and help spark a lasting interest in science. As a female scientist, I also see this as an opportunity to serve as a role model—especially for young girls who may not often see women represented in STEM fields. I hope that by sharing my journey, I can help show that pursuing science, research, and international education is possible and empowering, no matter your gender. This kind of representation matters, and I would be honoured to contribute to creating that visibility. I also see this experience as a chance to grow personally and professionally by learning from others—students, local teachers, and fellow educators. Science is a global, collaborative effort, and I believe that teaching in a new cultural context will broaden my perspective and make me a better communicator and researcher.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

In addition to my academic training, I have gained a range of experiences that I believe would support me in contributing meaningfully as a Science Corps Fellow.

One of the most relevant aspects of my PhD is that I conduct research with children between the ages of 6 and 12. This work has taught me how to engage with children in a way that is respectful, fun, and intellectually stimulating. I've had to explain complex neuroscience concepts to both children and their parents, often adapting scientific information into playful or relatable language. Through this, I've discovered how much I love communicating science to young audiences. Their openness, creativity, and curiosity are incredibly rewarding to work with, and I'm continually amazed by the questions they ask and the fresh perspectives they bring.

I have also taken on several mentoring roles during my PhD, supporting undergraduate and master's students with their projects. This included introducing them to experimental methods, helping them navigate data analysis, and providing feedback on presentations and written work. I really enjoy seeing students grow in confidence and independence, and I've learned how to tailor my guidance based on their individual needs and backgrounds.

Beyond the university, I've been involved in public science outreach events, such as open lab days and interactive science exhibitions for families. In these contexts, I helped develop simple, hands-on activities to introduce children and adolescents to basic concepts in psychology and neuroscience. These events reinforced how important it is to make science accessible, engaging, and empowering – especially for younger audiences who may be discovering it for the first time.

I also bring strong cross-cultural sensitivity and adaptability. I've travelled many countries such as Thailand, China, Portugal, and Tanzania. These experiences have shaped me into someone who is flexible, open-minded, and eager to learn from others.

Altogether, I believe my background in child-focused science, my experience mentoring and teaching, my commitment to outreach, and my intercultural awareness will help me contribute to the mission of Science Corps – not only as an educator, but also as someone who listens, learns, and builds meaningful connections in a new cultural environment.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

Administrative role in industry or academia

In science education

In science outreach

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the near future, I plan to continue my research journey through a postdoctoral position in neuroscience. This would allow me to further refine my expertise on the neural processes in the human brain. I am eager to expand my research and gain more experience in leading independent projects, while collaborating with experts from diverse fields. This phase of my career will deepen my understanding of the human brain and help me refine my skills as a scientist, all while contributing to the growing body of knowledge on brain development and cognition.

However, in the long term, I see myself taking a path that may diverge from traditional academia. Although I deeply value my research and the learning opportunities it provides, I am open to exploring other avenues where I can continue to work with neuroscience in ways that don't necessarily involve a university or laboratory setting. I envision transitioning into roles where I can apply my scientific expertise in more interdisciplinary or applied fields, such as science policy, industry, or education. I'm particularly interested in science communication and public outreach. My passion lies in making complex scientific topics, especially those related to the human brain, accessible to a broader audience. I believe there is a great need to bridge the gap between the scientific community and the general public, especially when it comes to understanding health, cognition, and behaviour. I could see myself to work in science communication, whether through writing, speaking, or educational programs. The ability to engage and inform the public about cutting-edge neuroscience is something I find incredibly rewarding. I would love to work with organizations or platforms that focus on public engagement, to break down complex concepts and promote scientific literacy in accessible, impactful ways. I also envision working with schools and community organizations, potentially developing programs or workshops that foster curiosity about science and help people understand its relevance to their everyday lives.

Ultimately, while I have a clear vision of how I'd like to contribute to the field, I'm also open to where the road may take me. The experience of working in diverse environments and collaborating with different professionals has shown me that there are many paths to explore, and I'm excited to see how my career might evolve as I gain new experiences and opportunities.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)

 [CV_Nina-Raduner.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

An email list in your institution

[Science Corps](#)